



# Personality and Values

Week 5 | Organizational Behavior and Quality

Official chapter focus: personality, fit, values, cultural values, and the situation–trait relationship.

Personality

Values

Fit & context

**Quality lens: Better person–job / person–organization fit → more reliable quality behavior**

**Core idea: personality sets the stage; values guide choices; situations activate behavior**

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*Keep the session focused on concepts with direct OB and quality-management value.*

## By the end of this session, students can:

1. Distinguish person–job fit and person–organization fit.
2. Define personality and explain how it is measured.
3. Compare MBTI and the Big Five.
4. Explain how situations activate traits.
5. Explain values and cultural values.
6. Apply personality and values to quality-oriented behavior.



## Session logic

- Who is the person?
- What role and organization fit that person?
- Which situation will activate which behavior?
- What quality outcome may follow?

## Practical focus

role design, staffing, team composition, ethical use of assessments, and quality culture alignment



# Opening Case: Leading the “Quiet Revolution”

*Chapter 4 opens with Beth Comstock and the value of situational adaptation.*

## Case idea

Beth Comstock was a senior innovation leader at GE. Although business is often treated as an extroverted activity, she identifies as more introverted and emphasizes observation, balance, and adapting to the situation.

## Discussion

- Does leadership always require extraversion?
- How can introversion support quality leadership?
- When should a person adapt behavior to fit the situation?
- What risks emerge when managers stereotype personality?

## Key message

**Personality traits matter, but behavior depends on fit and context.**

Quality connection: introversion may support careful listening, observation, reflection, and learning from quality problems.



*The chapter begins with fit: person–job fit and person–organization fit.*

## Person–Job Fit

The effort to match job requirements with personality characteristics.

Quality question: Does the person fit the behavioral demands of the role?

## Person–Organization Fit

People are attracted to and selected by organizations that match their values, and they leave organizations that are not compatible with their personalities.

Quality question: Do the person's values fit the quality culture?

## Why fit matters for quality

- Better fit supports satisfaction, commitment, task performance, and lower turnover.
- Poor fit may create defensiveness, low cooperation, resistance to feedback, and documentation errors.
- Fit is not only about technical qualifications; it includes behavioral and value alignment.

# Holland's Typology of Personality and Congruent Occupations

Personality–job fit theory: match the person to the occupational environment

| Type          | Personality characteristics                             | Congruent occupations                         |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Realistic     | Shy, genuine, persistent, stable, conforming, practical | Mechanic; operator; farmer                    |
| Investigative | Analytical, original, curious, independent              | Biologist; economist; mathematician           |
| Social        | Sociable, friendly, cooperative, understanding          | Social worker; teacher; counselor             |
| Conventional  | Conforming, efficient, practical, orderly               | Accountant; corporate manager; bank teller    |
| Enterprising  | Self-confident, ambitious, energetic, domineering       | Lawyer; real estate agent; public relations   |
| Artistic      | Imaginative, disorderly, idealistic, emotional          | Painter; musician; writer; interior decorator |

**Quality use: assign people to quality tasks where fit supports accuracy, analysis, service, compliance, initiative, or creativity.**



# What Is Personality?

*Use the official definition and measurement cautions.*

## Personality

The sum of ways in which an individual reacts to and interacts with others.

## Personality traits

Enduring characteristics that describe an individual's behavior.

## Measurement and caution

| Issue                    | Implication for managers                                                                |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Self-report surveys      | Useful, but scores may be affected by faking, pressure, mood, and self-presentation.    |
| Observer-ratings surveys | May predict job success more than self-ratings alone.                                   |
| Best practice            | Combine evidence; do not use personality as the only employment decision criterion.     |
| Quality caution          | Use personality insights ethically for fit, coaching, and team design—not stereotyping. |



*A widely used framework, but less supported by evidence than the Big Five.*

| Pair                               | Textbook descriptors                                                 |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Extraverted (E) vs Introverted (I) | Outgoing, sociable, assertive vs quiet and shy                       |
| Sensing (S) vs Intuitive (N)       | Practical, routine, details vs unconscious processes and big picture |
| Thinking (T) vs Feeling (F)        | Reason and logic vs personal values and emotions                     |
| Judging (J) vs Perceiving (P)      | Control, order, structure vs flexible and spontaneous                |

## Appropriate use

Training and development; helping employees understand each other; opening communication; reducing conflict.

## Limitation

Evidence is mixed and results should not be overused to predict job performance.

**Teaching point: MBTI is useful for reflection and communication, but the Big Five is stronger for predicting OB criteria.**

# The Big Five Personality Model

A stronger evidence base for predicting important OB outcomes

| Dimension                     | Official descriptor                                                      | Quality relevance                                         |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Conscientiousness</b>      | Responsible, dependable, persistent, and organized                       | Compliance, follow-up, documentation, reliability         |
| <b>Emotional stability</b>    | Calm, self-confident, and secure versus nervous, depressed, and insecure | Stable judgment under stress and safer decisions          |
| <b>Extraversion</b>           | Sociable, gregarious, and assertive                                      | Communication, leadership emergence, customer interaction |
| <b>Openness to experience</b> | Imagination, sensitivity, and curiosity                                  | Innovation, learning, adaptability to change              |
| <b>Agreeableness</b>          | Good-natured, cooperative, and trusting                                  | Teamwork, service behavior, reduced conflict              |

**Quality caution: no single trait guarantees quality behavior; use job analysis and fair evidence.**





*From the chapter exhibit: Big Five traits influence job performance, satisfaction, and other OB outcomes.*

| Trait               | Illustrative OB criteria influenced              | Quality implication                          |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Conscientiousness   | Higher performance; leadership; longevity        | Reliable task performance and follow-through |
| Emotional stability | Life/job satisfaction; lower stress and deviance | Fewer unsafe reactions under pressure        |
| Extraversion        | Leadership emergence; performance in social jobs | Stronger influence and service interaction   |
| Openness            | Training performance; creativity; adaptability   | Improvement, learning, innovation            |
| Agreeableness       | Better teamwork; helping; lower deviance         | Cooperation and customer care                |

**Quality implication: Big Five traits help managers think about fit, team composition, coaching, and risk—not labels.**



*The situation can strengthen, weaken, or activate the expression of personality.*

## Situation Strength Theory

Some situations pressure individuals to behave in similar ways; strong situations reduce the expression of personality differences.

## Trait Activation Theory (TAT)

Some jobs or situations provide cues that activate particular traits and make them more relevant to behavior.

| TAT example from Exhibit 4-4           | Trait more relevant          | Quality implication                     |
|----------------------------------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Detail and precision work              | Conscientiousness            | Fewer errors; stronger documentation    |
| Social influence / service interaction | Extraversion / Agreeableness | Better customer contact and cooperation |
| Innovation / improvement projects      | Openness                     | New ideas and learning                  |
| High-pressure or crisis work           | Emotional stability          | Calm judgment and safe decisions        |



*Chapter 4 highlights CSE, self-monitoring, and proactive personality as powerful behavior predictors.*

| Attribute                    | Meaning in OB                                                                                           | Quality relevance                                          |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Core self-evaluations (CSEs) | People's bottom-line conclusions about their capabilities, competence, and worth                        | Confidence in improvement, resilience, ownership           |
| Self-monitoring              | Ability to adjust behavior to external, situational factors                                             | Adapting communication with customers, auditors, and teams |
| Proactive personality        | Identifies opportunities, shows initiative, takes action, and perseveres until meaningful change occurs | Problem prevention and continuous improvement              |

**Management implication: use these attributes for coaching, role design, and team composition—not for unfair labeling.**

*Kept concise: these concepts support the main theme but should not crowd out personality frameworks and values.*



*Values underlie and explain attitudes, behaviors, and perceptions.*

## Values

Basic convictions that a specific mode of conduct or end-state of existence is personally or socially preferable to an opposite or converse mode.

## Value system

A hierarchy based on a ranking of an individual's values in terms of their intensity.

## Why values matter for quality

- Values influence ethical choices when procedures do not specify every action.
- Values shape whether people prioritize speed, accuracy, customer focus, learning, compliance, or fairness.
- Misaligned values can produce hidden defects, distorted data, weak cooperation, or resistance to corrective action.



*Milton Rokeach separates values into ends and means.*

| Type                | Textbook meaning                                                        | Examples                                                                 | Quality link                                      |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Terminal values     | Desirable end-states of existence; goals a person would like to achieve | Prosperity, freedom, health and well-being, meaning in life              | What outcomes the organization and employee value |
| Instrumental values | Preferable modes of behavior or means of achieving terminal values      | Autonomy, self-reliance, personal discipline, kindness, goal-orientation | How people behave while pursuing quality results  |

## Quality dilemma

A team may value “customer satisfaction” as an end-state but disagree about the means: flexibility, strict compliance, speed, fairness, or documentation discipline.

**Teaching point: quality values must define both outcomes and acceptable behavior.**

*Cultural values shape work-related expectations and behavior.*

| Dimension                           | Meaning for managers                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Power distance                      | Degree to which people accept unequal distribution of power.                              |
| Individualism vs collectivism       | Preference for acting as individuals versus members of groups.                            |
| Masculinity vs femininity           | Degree to which culture favors achievement, power, and control versus equality.           |
| Uncertainty avoidance               | Degree to which people feel threatened by uncertainty and prefer structure.               |
| Long-term vs short-term orientation | Future, thrift, persistence, and tradition versus present focus and readiness for change. |
| Indulgence vs restraint             | Enjoying life and fun versus regulating conduct through strict social norms.              |

**Quality application: cultural values affect feedback, error reporting, participation, authority, standardization, and change readiness.**



*Bring personality and values back to the purpose of Organizational Behavior and Quality.*



| Quality role                | Relevant fit issue                                   | Possible risk if misaligned                  |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Documentation / audit       | Conscientiousness + rule-regulated work              | Errors, weak follow-up, incomplete records   |
| Customer complaint handling | Agreeableness + emotional stability + service values | Defensiveness, poor listening, escalation    |
| Improvement team            | Openness + cooperation + learning values             | Routine fixes; limited innovation            |
| Corrective action owner     | Proactivity + accountability values                  | Delayed actions and repeated nonconformities |

# In-Class Activity: Fit, Traits, and Quality Risk

Small groups | 20 minutes

**Scenario: A hospital improvement team must reduce repeated documentation errors and patient complaint delays. Candidates differ in attention to detail, social skills, creativity, emotional stability, and values.**

| Step | Group task                                                                                           |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Choose the quality role: audit, complaint handling, improvement design, or frontline implementation. |
| 2    | Identify which Big Five trait should be most relevant and why.                                       |
| 3    | Use Holland’s typology to discuss occupational fit.                                                  |
| 4    | Use TAT: what job feature will activate the trait?                                                   |
| 5    | Identify a value conflict and one management safeguard.                                              |

**Deliverable: Person–Job Fit + Activated Trait + Value Safeguard + Quality Outcome.**





*Use the case to connect personality, values, and quality outcomes.*

## Case

A senior employee completes tasks quickly and has strong technical skills. However, he dismisses colleagues' ideas, avoids documenting lessons learned, and treats customer complaints as interruptions. Managers tolerate this behavior because his individual output is high. Over time, junior staff stop suggesting improvements and errors are repeated.

## Questions

1. Which Big Five traits may be relevant?
2. Which values appear dominant?
3. Is this poor person–organization fit?
4. Which situations activate risky behavior?
5. What should management change?

**Quality connection: individual output can damage system-level quality if values and behavior are misaligned.**



*End with the textbook's core implications for managers.*

## Key takeaways

1. Personality matters, but it does not explain all behavior.
2. Big Five traits have strong links to OB criteria.
3. Person–job fit and person–organization fit affect satisfaction, commitment, performance, and turnover.
4. Situation strength and trait activation shape whether personality predicts behavior.
5. Values underlie attitudes, behaviors, and perceptions.
6. Cultural values help managers think globally, but individuals vary within cultures.

## Assignment

Analyze a familiar role, team, or quality problem. Explain how personality, values, and fit may influence behavior and quality outcomes. Use Chapter 4 concepts and recommend two practical management actions.

## Preparation for Week 6

Next topic: Perception and Individual Decision Making. Identify one work decision that may have been affected by perception, attribution, stereotyping, overconfidence, or limited information.

**Thank you**